

New report calls to replace CEOs with AI to Reduce Water Usage

Posted by u/Ok-Feeling-1743 • 0 points • 4 comments

A new report shows Microsoft's water usage jumped 30% from 2021 to 2022, highlighting the environmental impact of the emerging AI industry. [One study] (<https://arxiv.org/abs/2304.03271>) found that chatting with ChatGPT for a bit uses half a liter of water. ([Source](<https://gizmodo.com/ai-this-week-time-to-replace-your-ceo-with-ai-1850826288>))

****The Tech Industry's Water Problem****

- * ***Data Centers Need Cooling*****: ** Data centers require huge amounts of water for cooling to operate properly, much of which is pumped from local supplies.
- * ***AI is Extremely Thirsty*****: ** AI systems like ChatGPT have far higher energy densities than normal servers, needing more power and thus more cooling and water.

****Microsoft's Increased Water Usage****

- * ***30% Increase*****: ** Microsoft's latest environmental report showed its water usage rose sharply by 30% from 2021 to 2022 as its AI operations accelerated.
- * ***Estimating GPT-3's Usage*****: ** A recent study projected it took around 700,000 liters just to train GPT-3 over a two week period, described as "extremely concerning."

****The Difficulty of Oversight****

- * ***Lack of Transparency*****: ** Most AI vendors don't release water usage data publicly, making oversight of their environmental impact difficult.
- * ***Few Options to Reduce Usage*****: ** There are ways to reduce the water needed for AI systems, but little evidence companies are widely adopting them.

****TL;DR:**** Microsoft's rising water consumption highlights the enormous, potentially unsustainable thirst that the expanding AI industry generates, raising environmental concerns. More transparency and mitigation efforts may be needed.

Comments

u/griff_the_unholy • 1 points • 2023-09-16 21:49 UTC

Is the water polluted or otherwise rendered unsafe for human consumption after it has been passed through a heat exchanger?

u/ExoticCardiologist46 • 1 points • 2023-09-16 21:27 UTC

Is this satire.

u/chubba5000 • 3 points • 2023-09-16 20:59 UTC

How is firing a CEO and replacing them with AI going to save water? Don't CEOs only drink like a gallon of water a day?

u/DeltaSingularity • 3 points • 2023-09-16 20:57 UTC

>Estimating GPT-3's Usage**:** A recent study projected it took around 700,000 liters just to train GPT-3 over a two week period, described as "extremely concerning."

This is such sensationalist drivel, trying to scare people with big concerning numbers. Depending on how you calculate it, [a single car can take up to 83000 liters of water] (<https://www.watercalculator.org/footprint/the-hidden-water-in-everyday-products/>) to manufacture when including all stages of production. Ford alone is producing nearly 10,000 cars *per day*, every day.

u/Turbulent_Radish_330 • 2 points • 2023-09-16 21:01 UTC

The 700,000 liters over 14 days is 13208 gallons per day for Americans. That's about 44 average American household. It's absolutely nothing for something on that scale.

u/DeltaSingularity • 2 points • 2023-09-16 21:03 UTC

And then it's not even like that water is being wasted or polluted, the water used to cool data-centers is often discharged right back into a river, clean and slightly warmer.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2023-09-16 20:47 UTC

Hey /u/Ok-Feeling-1743, if your post is a ChatGPT conversation screenshot, please reply with the [conversation link](<https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq>) or prompt. Thanks!

We have a [public discord server](<https://discord.com/servers/r-chatgpt-1050422060352024636>). There's a free Chatgpt bot, Open Assistant bot (Open-source model), AI image generator bot, Perplexity AI bot, 🤖 GPT-4 bot ([Now with Visual capabilities (cloud vision)!](<https://cdn.discordapp.com/attachments/812770754025488386/1095397431404920902/image0.jpg>)) and channel for latest prompts! New Addition: Adobe Firefly bot and Eleven Labs cloning bot! [So why not join us?](<https://discord.com/servers/1050422060352024636>))

[NEW: Google x FlowGPT Prompt Hackathon 🤖](<https://redd.it/16ehnis>)

PSA: For any Chatgpt-related issues email support@openai.com

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